History showcases his glass-mosaic murals depicting cityscapes, nature and animal motifs, even a vermillion Ganesha and a striking rendition of 'The Last Supper'. Alongside these, his hand-painted ceramic tiles and plates, a mosaic floor lamp, watercolours and book illustrations are also on display.

This is the first retrospective showcase of the pieces produced at the studio. "Badri Narayan's vision of integrating art with architecture and public space anticipates current discussions about India's urban development. It is a way to critically examine public art today," says Puja Vaish, curator of the exhibition and director of the Jehangir Nicholson Art Foundation. Apart from Narayan's works, the exhibition also highlights several other artists working in the city during this period, including Vijoo Sadwelkar, V.M. Raikar, Sudha Madan and Naren Panchal. "By recovering overlooked chapters, the exhibition demonstrates the importance of expanding the canon of Indian art beyond established narratives," says Vaish. ■

—Prachi Joshi

The exhibition continues until August 31



QUIET GAZE A video grab of 'Pati, 2010/2020'

real to others often feels ordinary to me. I try not to fix meaning too tightly. We're obsessed with binary answers, but the world is shaped by complex systems.

Q. Much of your work begins from a personal space. How do you navigate between personal catharsis and public storytelling?

I find it easier to start small, because I often don't fully understand what I'm doing.... Clarity takes time, and sometimes personal and public overlap. ■

—with Nikhil Sardana

CINEMA ▼

RETURN OF A **CLASSIC**

A 4K restored version of Muzaffar Ali's *Umrao Jaan* is set to release later this month



CALLING US ALL *The restored Umrao Jaan will release at select PVR INOX cinemas on June 27*

It's a dream come true for director Muzaffar Ali as his iconic Rekha-starrer *Umrao Jaan* readies for a second innings. The film, says Ali, "has survived multiple generational and technological transitions... and each generation has found something deeply personal , valuable and enduring in its artistic and emotional tapestry."

Luckily, the film was never given to an OTT platform and has preserved its aura. Ali says that working frame by frame with the original negative has been an emotional pilgrimage both for the original creative team and the technicians who helped resurrect it.

This has also given birth to a 240-page coffee table book—*Muzaffar Ali's Umrao Jaan*—which features nearly 250 rare images of both behind-the-scenes and captured cinematic moments.

For Ali, *Umrao Jaan* is "a journey into the intangible world of memory—of my past, of the Lucknow of my mother, her universe of textiles, *tehzeeb*, and the muted light and shadows of its seasons." The movie, adds Ali, "is a layered, cerebral pilgrimage". "Asha Bhosle's voice crossed the known to enter the unknown world of Lucknow. Everything found its consummation in Umrao Jaan—a Rekha from 2,000 km away, yet one who fully became the soul of the character." ■

—Shashi Sunny